

W T P

UAE Banking Readiness Checklist

Is Your Profile Bank-Ready?

A self-assessment tool by WTP — your UAE execution partner

How to Use

Mark each item: **G** = ready, **Y** = partial, **R** = not ready. Count your greens at the end.



Section 1: Source of Funds

Banks will reconstruct the origin of every significant deposit. "I earned it" is not sufficient.

☐

1 Primary income documentation

12+ months of bank statements, tax returns, or audited financials.

☐

2 Business revenue trail

Invoices, contracts, and corresponding bank credits — not just a balance.

☐

3 Investment and capital gains history

Brokerage statements, notarized sale agreements, or share transfer documents.

☐

4 Gift or inheritance documentation

Legal documents: probate, gift deed, notarized declaration.

☐

5 Clean chain from origin to current account

Traceable path without gaps or unregulated intermediaries.



Section 2: Business Structure

The wrong structure causes more rejections than bad documentation.

☐

6 Jurisdiction matches business activity

Free zone or mainland aligns with what you actually do.

☐

7 License covers actual revenue streams

Every revenue stream is covered by the trade license.

☐

8 Substance is demonstrable

Office lease (not virtual), local staff or directors, local decisions.

☐

9 Ownership structure is transparent

Full UBO chain, no nominees or opaque trusts.

☐

10 Group structure is explainable

Each entity's role, intercompany flows, and rationale.



Section 3: Personal Profile

Banks run KYC on every shareholder, director, and signatory.



11 No PEP or PEP-adjacent exposure

Not a PEP, no close ties to PEPs. If yes — EDD pack ready.



12 No sanctions exposure

You, partners, counterparties not on any sanctions list.



13 Nationality is not a blocking factor

Passport not from restricted jurisdiction. Or second one available.



14 Residency history is consistent

Stated history matches travel, taxes, and banking records.



15 Clean compliance record

No account closures, investigations, or adverse media.



Section 4: Documentation

Having these ready cuts processing time from months to weeks.



16 Passport copies

All shareholders, directors, signatories. Valid 6+ months.



17 Proof of address

Recent (< 3 months). Utility bill, bank statement, or gov document.



18 CV / professional biography

1–2 pages per UBO: career, industry, reason for UAE.



19 Business plan or activity description

What, who, volumes, revenue. 3–5 pages minimum.



20 Reference letters

Bank reference (good standing) + professional reference.



Section 5: Red Flags

A single red here can override a high overall score.



21 No cash-intensive business without controls

Documented AML procedures and audited cash handling.



22 No cryptocurrency as primary business

VARA license or equivalent. Unlicensed = automatic decline.



23 No transactions with high-risk jurisdictions

Or documented compliance framework addressing this.



24 No shell company indicators

Real clients, operational expenses, business purpose.



25 No "just register me" attitude

Full cooperation with bank due diligence expected.

Your Score

20–25	GREEN	Bank-ready. Standard processing timeline.
15–19	YELLOW	Fixable issues. 2–6 weeks preparation needed.
< 15	RED	Significant preparation. Professional pre-screening recommended.

A single red item in Section 5 can override a high overall score.

Next Step

WTP's Banking-First methodology assesses bankability before company registration.

Request Your Free Banking Roadmap

- Pre-screening: 5–7 business days, no charge
- GO / NO-GO decision before any fees
- If NO-GO: written explanation of what needs to change

WTP

Banking-First Wealth Transfer Platform

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This checklist is for informational and self-assessment purposes only. It does not constitute legal, tax, or financial advice. Banking requirements vary by institution. WTP does not guarantee account opening.